MIDNIGHT MARKETING · MARKETING COORDINATOR SKILL ASSESSMENT

CRESTLINE CASE STUDY, READY FOR MIDLAND.

One four-minute voice note from Megan. Below: the recap I'd send her, the plan to get a printed case study into Midland on time, the creative brief, every gap that needs an answer first, and a first draft of the piece itself.

By **Durva Thakkar** Client **Megan** Printer deadline **Mon, Nov 9**

Conference **Nov 14 to 16, Midland**

00 WHAT I HEARD

Megan's note was quick and a little scattered, which is normal for a busy client. These are the moments that change the work. The red ones are the easiest to miss and the most expensive to get wrong.



0:00 4:00

0:15

The ask: a Crestline case study

Best run data they've had. Sales keeps mentioning it but has nothing to hand anyone.

0:36 to 1:05

The numbers

Curve and lateral in one run, one BHA, no trips. Lateral about 10,500 ft at 92 ft/hr average. About 15% faster than offsets.

1:15

6 days is the wrong well

"Six" is Reeves County. Crestline is 4.5 days ahead of plan. Only 4.5 goes anywhere near this piece.

1:50

The series idea is parked

"Don't do anything with that." It goes in the recap as parked, and we don't act on it.

2:00

Format: printed, with weight

A handout for the conference, "not a flimsy brochure". Photos might exist; she'd have to ask around.

2:28

The real deadline is the 9th

Conference is the 14th to 16th in Midland, but the printer needs five business days. Files are due the 9th.

3:04

The market: price pressure

Bigger directional companies are cutting day rates. Sales is getting beaten on price. This shapes the message.

3:29

A second ask, tucked at the end

Refresh the one-pagers for the other three service lines. Small, but it needs its own timeline.

01 RECAP EMAIL

Sent the same day as the voice note. Megan is travelling tomorrow, so it's built to be read on a phone: decisions and asks first, details after. I'd also text her the three urgent asks, since she said that's the best way to reach her.

To Megan

Subject **Crestline case study: plan + 5 things we need (files to printer Nov 9)**

Hi Megan,

Thanks for the voice note. Here's what we heard, the plan, and what we need from you. Short version: one printed Crestline case study for Midland, with files at the printer by **Monday, Nov 9**. We're aiming for Friday, Nov 6 to leave a day of buffer.

WHAT YOU ASKED FOR

1. A printed Crestline case study to hand out at the Midland conference (Nov 14 to 16). Heavy and well made, not a flimsy brochure.
2. A refresh of the one-pagers for your other three service lines.

THE CRESTLINE STORY, AS WE UNDERSTOOD IT

- Curve and lateral drilled in one run, with one BHA and no trips
- Lateral of about 10,500 ft, averaging 92 ft/hr
- About 15% faster than the offset wells
- About 4.5 days ahead of plan (the 6 days is the Reeves County well, so we'll keep that out)
- Crestline's drilling engineer said on the call that it saved them real money

We'll check every number against the run report before anything goes to print.

HOW WE'LL FRAME IT

Since the bigger directional companies are cutting day rates, the piece will lead with days saved, not day rate. A lower day rate is a discount. Four and a half fewer days is a real saving. That gives your sales team something to say when price comes up.

KEY DATES

Wed, Nov 4	First draft (copy and layout) to you
Thu, Nov 5	Your feedback, one round, by noon
Fri, Nov 6	Your final OK, files to the printer
Mon, Nov 9	Printer's hard deadline (our backup day)
Tue, Nov 10	Digital version to your sales team
Fri, Nov 13	Printed copies delivered in Midland

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

1. **By Mon, Nov 2:** Crestline's OK to use their name, logo and data. If they need more time or say no, we'll build an "a Permian operator" version so the date doesn't move.
2. **By Mon, Nov 2:** the run report for the well, including the offset wells behind the 15%.
3. **By Tue, Nov 3:** the drilling engineer's name and title, and whether they're OK being quoted.
4. **By Tue, Nov 3:** any photos from the pad. If none turn up, the design works without them, so nothing waits on photos.
5. **By Wed, Nov 4:** printer contact, how many copies, and where to ship in Midland (booth number or venue).

ONE QUICK QUESTION

Do you need the refreshed one-pagers at the conference too? If yes, they also have to make the Nov 9 deadline. If not, we'll start them the week after Midland, when there's room to do them well.

PARKED

The idea of a case study for every strong well. No action from us; it's yours for the next-quarter conversation.

Safe travels tomorrow. I'll text you the first three asks so they're easy to answer on the road.

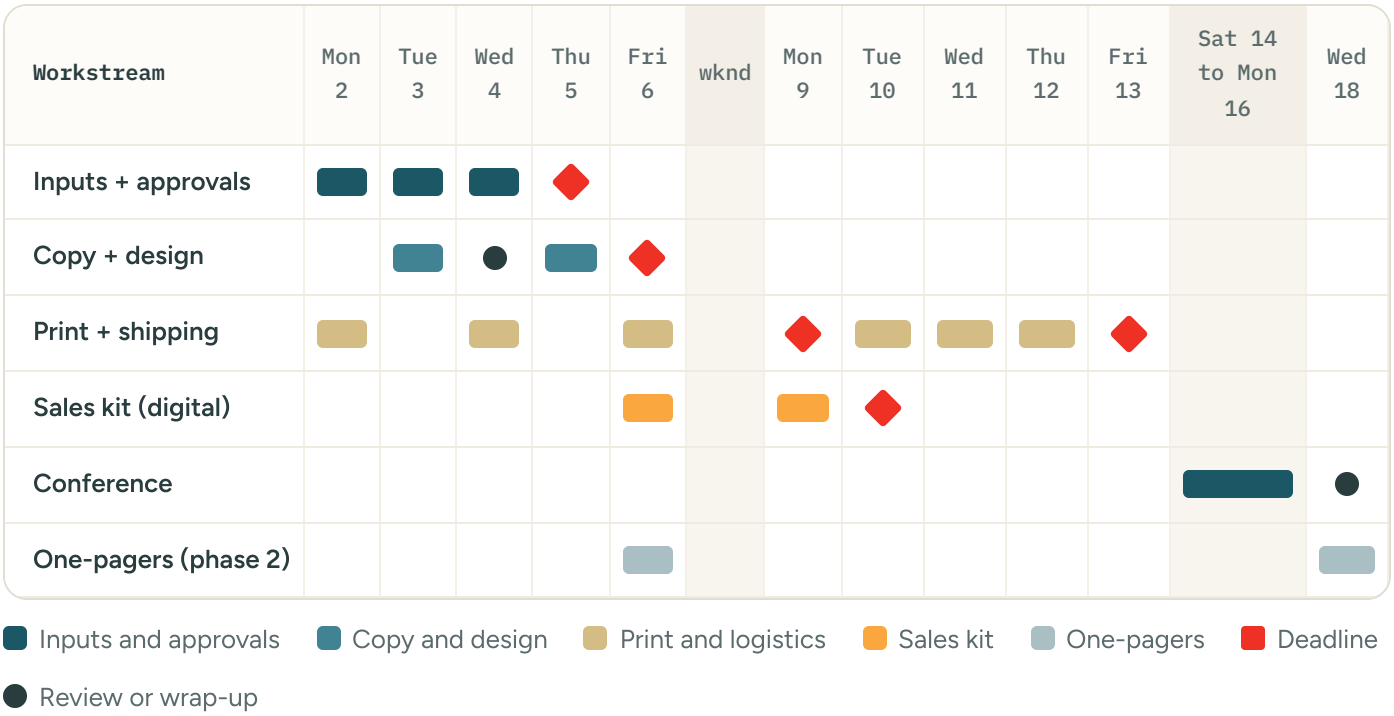
Thanks,
Durva

02

EXECUTION PLAN

Working back from the printer, not the conference. There are six working days between kickoff and the printer deadline, so the plan protects the two things that can't be rushed: Crestline's approval and the number check.

The date math doesn't leave room. Nov 14 is a Saturday. If files land Monday the 9th and the printer takes five business days, printing finishes Friday the 13th, the day before the conference opens, with no time left to ship to Midland. That's why we aim for Friday the 6th, and why "does five days include delivery?" is the first question for the printer. Nov 11 is Veterans Day, so I'd also check the printer and carrier are working that day.



Day by day

Mon, Nov 2
Kickoff

- Recap email out; text Megan the three urgent asks `Midnight`
- Megan asks Crestline for permission (name, logo, data, quote) `Megan`
- Internal kickoff: brief to copywriter and designer, pull brand files and current one-pagers `Midnight`
- Send the printer specs and ask for a quote, stock availability, and whether five days includes delivery `Printer`

Tue, Nov 3
Facts locked

- Check every number against the run report, including which offsets make up the 15% Midnight
- Copy v1 and layout direction. Photo decision by end of day: real photos if they're print quality, otherwise the well-path graphic Midnight
- Start the anonymized "Permian operator" version in parallel, so Crestline's answer can't stall us Midnight

Wed, Nov 4
Draft to client

- v1 PDF to Megan with a short note on what to look at (numbers, quote, tone) Midnight
- Lock paper stock, quantity, quote and ship-to address with the printer Printer

Thu, Nov 5
Feedback

- One consolidated round of feedback from Megan by noon Megan
- Crestline go/no-go by end of day. No answer means we print the anonymized version Megan
- v2 with changes in, internal proofread by someone who hasn't seen it yet Midnight

Fri, Nov 6
Our target

- Final OK from Megan by 2 PM Megan
- Preflight: 0.125" bleed, CMYK, 300 dpi images, fonts embedded, QR tested on two phones Midnight
- Files to the printer. Quick audit note on the three one-pagers: what looks dated and what needs new info Midnight

Mon, Nov 9
Printer deadline

- Backup day if anything slipped. Approve the printer's digital proof the same day Midnight
- Digital PDF and the QR landing page go live Midnight

Tue, Nov 10
Sales kit

- Digital case study, a short talk track for price questions, and an email template to the sales team Midnight
- Optional: a "find us in Midland" LinkedIn post for Megan's company page Midnight

Nov 11 to 13
Print and ship

- Check on the print run Wednesday; get tracking Thursday; confirm delivery in Midland Friday Printer
- Backup plan: someone travelling to Midland carries one box of copies Megan

Nov 14 to 16
Conference

- Copies at the booth; QR scans tracked through UTM tags Megan

Wed, Nov 18
Wrap-up

- Short report: copies handed out, QR scans, meetings booked, and what sales heard at the booth Midnight
- Start the one-pager refresh, done in about two weeks with one review round Midnight

Risks and what we'd do

RISK	PLAN
Crestline is slow or says no	Anonymized "Permian operator" version runs in parallel from Tuesday. Same design, swap one line.
Numbers in the run report don't match the call	Print only what the report confirms. Flag any difference to Megan in writing before the draft.
No usable photos	The design is built around a well-path graphic, so photos are a bonus, not a dependency.
Heavy stock or special finish adds days	Pick a stock the printer has in house by Wednesday. Skip finishes that add time.
Shipping misses Friday	Ship to the venue or hotel with tracking. Someone travelling carries a box as backup. The QR and the digital PDF still work at the booth.
Megan can't review while travelling	Name a backup approver on Monday. Keep the review to one clear PDF and three questions, so it's quick on a phone.

03 CREATIVE BRIEF

One page the copywriter, designer and printer can all work from. Anything still waiting on Megan is listed under gaps.

PROJECT

Crestline well case study. Printed handout for the Midland conference (Nov 14 to 16), plus a digital version the sales team can send after calls.

BACKGROUND

The Crestline run is one of the best the client has had: curve and lateral in one run, no trips. Sales brings it up on calls but has nothing to leave behind. Meanwhile, bigger directional companies are cutting day rates and reps are losing ground on price.

OBJECTIVE

Give sales proof that moves the conversation from day rate to days and total well cost. At the booth, the piece should start conversations and lead to follow-up meetings.

AUDIENCE

- **Primary:** operator drilling engineers, drilling superintendents and managers at the conference. Technical, skeptical of marketing, trust numbers.
- **Secondary:** prospects on sales calls, and procurement weighing day rates.

WHAT WE WANT THEM TO DO

Keep the piece, scan the QR for the digital version, and talk to sales about their next curve and lateral.

SINGLE-MINDED MESSAGE

ONE RUN. NO TRIPS. 4.5 DAYS BACK.

The reason to believe: the numbers, from a named operator, checked against the run report. The idea underneath it: **the cheapest day is the one you don't need.**

PROOF POINTS (TO VERIFY AGAINST THE RUN REPORT)

1 run	0	~10,500 ft	92 ft/hr	~15%
curve + lateral, one BHA	trips	lateral length	average ROP in the lateral	faster than offset wells

Plus: **4.5 days ahead of plan**, and a quote from Crestline's drilling engineer if approved. **Not** the 6 days (that's Reeves County).

TONE

Plain, confident, engineer-to-engineer. Numbers do the talking. No hype words, no "revolutionary". Short sentences a busy superintendent can read in 30 seconds standing at a booth.

HEADLINE OPTIONS

A One run. No trips. 4.5 days back. *(recommended)*

B The cheapest day is the one you don't need.

C Curve to lateral, one BHA, zero trips.

FORMAT AND SPECS (TO CONFIRM WITH PRINTER)

- 8.5" × 11", printed both sides
- Heavy cover stock (about 130 lb / 350 gsm), matte, so it feels like a reference card, not a flyer
- CMYK, 0.125" bleed, 300 dpi images
- Upgrade if budget and time allow: 11" × 17" folded to four pages
- Digital: same layout as a PDF under 2 MB for email

STRUCTURE

- **Front:** headline, two-line story, well-path graphic, four big numbers
- **Back:** why it matters (days, not day rate), ask / what we did / result, speed vs. offsets, days vs. plan, engineer quote, "4.5 days × your spread cost", call to action with QR

MUST INCLUDE

- Client logo and brand (guidelines needed)
- Crestline's written OK; engineer's OK for the quote
- Short disclaimer: results from one well, conditions vary
- QR with UTM tags, booth number, sales contact

MUST AVOID

- Naming or attacking competitors, or quoting day rates
- Any Reeves County numbers
- "Series" branding. That idea is parked
- Any number the run report doesn't support

HOW WE'LL MEASURE IT

- Copies handed out (count left over)
- QR scans and digital views, by UTM
- Meetings booked from the conference
- How many reps send the PDF in the next 30 days

TIMELINE AND APPROVALS

- Draft Wed Nov 4, feedback Thu Nov 5, final Fri Nov 6
- Printer hard deadline Mon Nov 9
- **Approvers:** Megan (final), Crestline (name and data), drilling engineer (quote)
- **Budget:** to confirm

04 GAPS TO CLARIFY

Sorted by what blocks work. The first group has to be answered before copy is final; the second before files go to print; the third can wait.

Blocks the work

Need by Mon to Tue

01 **Can we name Crestline?**
Operators often keep well data private. We need written permission to use their name, logo and numbers. If not, is "a Permian operator" OK?

02 **Where's the run report?**
We'll check 10,500 ft, 92 ft/hr and 4.5 days against it. Also: total footage in the run, well dates, and county or area.

03 **15% faster at what?**
Rate of penetration, or days on the well? Compared to which offset wells, and how many? This is the claim competitors will poke at, so it has to be airtight.

04 **4.5 days against which plan?**
Crestline's AFE or drilling plan? What were planned vs. actual days? This lets us draw the chart to scale.

05 **The drilling engineer's quote**
Exact words, name, title, and their OK to be quoted. If they won't be named, can we use "Drilling Engineer, Crestline"?

06 **How much technical detail can we share?**
Motor or rotary steerable, bit, parameters. Engineers will want it; it may also be something the client prefers to keep private.

Needed before print

Need by Wed

07 **The conference**

Event name, booth number, expected traffic (this sets the quantity), and the exact shipping address. Also confirming the dates: Nov 14 to 16 runs Saturday to Monday.

08 **The printer**

Their printer or ours? Does "five business days" include delivery to Midland? If it doesn't, the 9th is already too late.

09 **Budget**

A number for printing and any finish upgrade, so we can choose stock and quantity once instead of going back and forth.

10 **Photos**

Who has them, and are they high resolution (300 dpi at print size)? Do we need the crew's permission to show faces or rig names?

11 **Brand files**

Logo files, fonts, colours and guidelines. Who besides Megan has to approve?

12 **The call to action**

Who should a prospect contact: one rep, a general sales line, or a page on the website? Where should the QR point?

13 **Dollar value**

Can we show what 4.5 days was worth in dollars, using Crestline's spread cost? If not, the "4.5 days × your spread cost" line lets readers do the math with their own number.

14 **Legal review**

Does a performance claim need legal or compliance review on the client side? If yes, it needs a slot before Friday.

Can wait

After Midland

15 **One-pagers: timing**

Needed for the conference, or after? This is the one answer we need now, because it decides whether they share the Nov 9 deadline.

16 **One-pagers: scope**

Which three service lines? What feels dated: the look, the content, or both? Are the source files available (InDesign, Canva)? Is this covered by the current scope, or a separate estimate?

17 **Backup approver**

Who can sign off if Megan is on the road and can't review?

18 **"Next month"**

The plan assumes the conference is in November 2026. If the voice note was recorded earlier, every date shifts back with it.

+ EXTRA: A FIRST DRAFT

Not asked for, but it makes the brief easier to react to. A real draft of the front and back, using only what Megan said on the call. Anything unconfirmed is clearly marked; nothing is made up.

Works without photos

The well-path graphic shows the whole story (curve, lateral, one run), so the design doesn't wait on someone finding a camera.

Answers the price question

The back page turns "4.5 days" into the reader's own money: 4.5 days times their spread cost. No invented dollar figures.

Easy to anonymize

If Crestline says no, "Crestline" becomes "a Permian operator" in three places and nothing else changes.

+ EXTRA: SALES KIT

Megan said the sales team has "nothing to hand anybody" and is getting beaten up on price. The printed piece covers the booth; these cover the other 50 weeks of the year. Small, fast, and off the critical path.

TALK TRACK: WHEN PRICE COMES UP

```
"I get it, day rates are coming down
everywhere. The question is what the
well
costs, not the day.

On Crestline's well we drilled the
curve and
the lateral in one run, no trips,
and they
finished four and a half days early.

What's a day worth on your rig?
Multiply
that by four and a half."
```

FOLLOW-UP EMAIL FOR REPS

```
Subject: The Crestline run (1 page)

Hi {first name},

Good talking today. Here's the run I
mentioned:
curve and lateral in one run, one
BHA, no trips,
and 4.5 days ahead of plan.

[Crestline case study, PDF]

Happy to walk through how we'd plan
your next
curve and lateral.

{rep name}
```

QR TRACKING

```
utm_source=midland-conference
utm_medium=print
utm_campaign=crestline-case-study
utm_content=booth-handout
```

The sales email PDF uses **utm_medium=email**, so we can see which one drives more visits.

PARKED, ON PURPOSE

Megan's idea of a case study for every strong well sounds like a great next-quarter project. She asked us to forget it, so we have. The only thing I'd do now is keep this layout clean and reusable, which costs nothing extra.

Durva Thakkar · Marketing Coordinator Skill Assessment for Midnight Marketing. Task 2 walkthrough video is attached to the submission email.